

— EDITION 24

The Fintech Hype Cycle Reality Check

*We were promised that neobanks would
destroy traditional banking by 2025.
Instead, traditional banks just bought their
features. Here's why.*

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 07

A Candid Look at Fintech Hype Cycles.

The tech world regularly falls in love with cosmetic overhauls while ignoring underlying structural realities. To accurately predict the agentic economy, we must dissect why previous waves stalled.

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The Flaw of the Neobank CAC Model.

Early digital banks spent aggressively on venture capital to acquire customers with sleek visual apps and free checking accounts, but struggled to build profitable lending portfolios.

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Why 'Super Apps' Failed to Capture the West.

The Western financial landscape remains heavily fragmented by deep-seated consumer regulatory divides and entrenched payment network preferences, resisting consolidation into a single consumer app.

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Infrastructure Upgrades Always Outlast UI Novelties.

Sleek frontend designs are easily copied.
Lasting, structural enterprise value in fintech
is built by teams who solve hard back-end
processing, ledger speed, and compliance
bottlenecks.

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Why Agentic Commerce Isn't a UI Trend.

Agentic commerce is the ultimate back-end evolution. It is not about launching another consumer app; it is about completely re-plumbing core transaction systems to interface with autonomous code engines.

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The Metric to Focus on For Lasting Value.

Stop looking at superficial user signups. The ultimate measure of lasting value in the coming financial landscape is programmatic transaction retention and API processing volume.

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Save This: The Hype-Cycle Filter.

1) Neobanks: great CAC story, weak lending economics. 2) Super apps: blocked by fragmentation and regulation. 3) UI is copyable; infrastructure compounds. 4) Agentic commerce is back-end re-plumbing, not an app trend. The metric that matters: *programmatic transaction retention and API volume.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

Hype or **shift?**

Comment the most over-hyped thing in fintech right now. Repost to share it, and follow for daily agentic payments breakdowns.

◆ Joseph Bankole